SOP-10 · CUSTOMER SUPPORT · SAMPLE WORK PRODUCT

SOP: Handling a Double-Charge Complaint

Written from a senior agent's scattered notes so any new support hire can resolve a double charge the same way, first time, by email or chat.

OWNER: **Support team lead** APPLIES TO: **Email and chat support**

TIME TO RESOLVE: **~10 minutes**

1 · Before you reply

- ✓ **Verify:** Confirm the customer's name and the last 4 digits of the card on file. Never discuss charges before this.
- ✓ **Find both charges:** Billing → Transactions. Match the date, amount and reference number the customer gave.
- ✓ **Check the status:** "Pending" charges drop off on their own in 3–5 business days. "Posted" charges need a refund.

2 · Decide what happened

USE THE FIRST ROW THAT MATCHES

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
Two posted charges, same amount, same day	True duplicate	Refund one charge now (step 3)
One posted + one pending	Card authorization hold	Explain it drops in 3–5 days; set a reminder to check
Two charges, different amounts	Likely plan change or prorated bill	Explain the line items; escalate if still unclear

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
Only one charge on our side	Bank or card issue	Send our transaction record; suggest calling the bank

3 · Fix it, then reply

- ✓ **Refund:** Transactions → select the duplicate → Refund → reason "Duplicate charge". Copy the refund ID.
- ✓ **Note the account:** "Duplicate charge [date, amount] refunded, ID [refund ID], customer informed."
- ✓ **Reply:** Use the template below. Fix first, then talk. If they mentioned cancelling, answer that last.

REPLY TEMPLATE: true duplicate — Replace the [brackets]

Hi [Name],

You're right, you were charged twice for [month]'s bill, and I'm sorry for the trouble. I've already refunded the extra [amount]. Your refund ID is [ID], and it usually shows on your statement within 5–7 business days.

I've also noted your account so this doesn't need explaining again. If it hasn't appeared by [date], just reply here and I'll chase it personally.

Sign with your own name · Never promise a faster refund than 5–7 business days

4 · When to escalate

- ✓ The amount is over **$500**, or it's the customer's **third** billing complaint in 90 days
- ✓ The customer mentions a **lawyer, chargeback or the BBB**
- ○ Escalate to the team lead with the account note and refund ID. Tell the customer who is taking over and by when.

WHY THIS SOP WORKS

Every step is one action a new hire can follow without asking anyone. The decision table covers the four situations that cause most double-charge tickets, and the template fixes the problem before it apologizes, so the customer reads the solution first.

SAMPLE WORK PRODUCT · Prepared by Jade Xyrus Abejero · 2026

A sample SOP for a made-up company. Based on billing-support practice from my U.S. telecom work.